16.3 Neonatal Jaundice and Phototherapy*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says, "The baby looks yellow." **Objective** • Jaundice down to the chest on day 3 • Serum bilirubin above the treatment line • Sleepy at feeds	**ACTUAL** Neonatal hyperbilirubinemia related to immature hepatic function and delayed feeding as evidenced by jaundice and raised bilirubin.	• Bilirubin falls below the treatment line.	• Start phototherapy as ordered, with eye protection. • Expose as much skin as possible and reposition per policy. • Feed at least every 3 hours. • Check bilirubin as ordered.	• Outcome reached as bilirubin falls.
Subjective • Mother asks, "Can I hold my baby?" **Objective** • Baby under phototherapy • Mother tearful	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety [parental] related to infant treatment and separation as evidenced by questioning and worry.	• Mother understands the treatment and joins in care.	• Explain what phototherapy does and how long it is likely to last. • Let her hold the baby for feeds, per policy. • Encourage her to keep breastfeeding.	• Considered met when the mother takes part.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Phototherapy	**RISK** Risk for inadequate fluid volume as evidenced by risk factors: increased insensible losses during phototherapy.	• Baby stays well hydrated.	• Count wet diapers. • Weigh daily. • Follow temperature. • Feed at least every 3 hours.	• Goal reached while the baby is hydrated.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [38], [41]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.